Your guide to the clue workshop

ADULT ONLY - contains answers. Keep this guide separate from the six player sheets.

What this pack includes

Six independent puzzles: two codes, two logic tasks and two routes. They can be used separately or in any order. This is not a complete story-based escape room; there are no physical locks, timer or required room search.

Print and prepare

Print the six player pages single-sided at 100% on matching US Letter paper. One complete player set per team is a starting point. Read this four-page guide on screen, or print it once. Prepare pencils. No colour-dependent clue is used.

Choose a starting point

The puzzles are designed for children aged 6-12 with adult help as needed. Reading and experience vary. Inspect the sheets first. Try the secret stamp, delivery queue or forest trail before the shifted message or harbour crossing.

Share the information

For puzzle 4, an adult can cut the three helper clues from beneath the diagram and give one to each player. Leave the parcel picture and question intact. Players tell one another their clues and agree on the parcel. With fewer players, take turns or let the adult read a clue.

Help without giving everything away

Ask players to explain their thinking before checking the answer. Give one hint at a time; allow another attempt before the next hint. The last hint can be very direct. If the group wants to stop, read the explained solution together.

How you may use these files

Print for your own household or the classes you teach. Retain the Paper Adventure credit. Do not resell or republish these PDF files; share the public page link instead. These are original Paper Adventure puzzle materials.

Codes: hints and solutions

01 - The secret stamp

Hint 1: Each shape stands for one letter. All the letters you need are in the key.

Hint 2: Match the circle first, then the triangle, then the square.

Hint 3: Write the three matching letters in the same order as the large stamps.

Answer: OAK

The circle gives O, the triangle A and the square K. Together they spell OAK: the parcel belongs at the oak tree.

02 - The moon-station message

Hint 1: Find a sent letter in the lower row. Read the original letter directly above it.

Hint 2: F becomes C, K becomes H and H becomes E. The first word begins CHE.

Hint 3: Decode the whole message, then answer with only the colour it names.

Answer: RED

Moving each sent letter back three places gives CHECK THE RED STAR. The requested colour is RED.

Logic: hints and solutions

03 - The delivery queue

Hint 1: Put SUN in the first position before trying the other parcels.

Hint 2: Keep STAR and MOON together, in that order. Try the two places where that pair could fit.

Hint 3: If STAR and MOON were second and third, LEAF would be last. That breaks a clue.

Answer: MOON

SUN must be first. STAR-MOON cannot occupy positions two and three, because that leaves LEAF last. The only order is SUN, LEAF, STAR, MOON. MOON goes last.

04 - The right parcel

Hint 1: A parcel must satisfy all three helpers, not just one of them.

Hint 2: Cross out B because its wrapping has dots. Compare the seals and stamp counts on the others.

Hint 3: A has too few stamps and D has the wrong seal. Which parcel is left?

Answer: C

C has stripes, a triangle seal and two stamps. A fails the stamp clue, B fails the wrapping clue and D fails the seal clue. Only C matches all three.

Routes: hints and solutions

05 - The forest trail

Hint 1: East is right, south is down and west is left. Each move travels exactly one square.

Hint 2: Your first two moves land on B and R. Write those down in that order.

Hint 3: After B and R, move down, left, down and right. Keep one letter from every landing square.

Answer: BRIDGE

The six landing squares give B, R, I, D, G and E. They spell BRIDGE. The starting S is not part of the message.

06 - The harbour crossing

Hint 1: Because MILL is forbidden, the first bridge must go from DOCK to OAK.

Hint 2: You must visit BELL and use only three bridges in total. Compare OAK's two onward choices.

Hint 3: The route is DOCK > OAK > BELL > BEACON. Read the numbers on those three bridges in order.

Answer: 258

Avoiding MILL forces DOCK-OAK. To visit BELL within three bridges, continue OAK-BELL-BEACON. The bridge numbers are 2, 5 and 8, giving 258.